

"AN INNOCUOUS PERSON FOR PRIME MINISTER."



So said a Delhi journal *Thought*, in 1966. When the Congress Parliamentary Party voted to choose a prime minister, this "mere *chokri*" (chit of a girl), as Morarji Desai called Indira Gandhi, defeated him by 255 votes to 169. The new prime minister was faced not just with an economy dependent on the US's "ship-to-mouth" approach but vicious personal attacks in Parliament and a lack of confidence within the party. Even an Alabama newspaper did not spare her when she met US President Johnson during her world tour in 1966. Its headline? 'New Indian Leader Comes Begging'.

- The Indonesian and Malayan governments declared that the war over the future of the island of Borneo was over.
- Temples of Abu Simble moved to make way for Aswan Dam.
- Mao Zedong's (below) Cultural Revolution began in China which witnessed a revolutionary upsurge by Chinese



AP students and workers against the bureaucrats of the Chinese Communist Party. The revolution continued until Mao died in 1976.

MIZO FRONT MAN Laldenga

Mizoram had been dissatisfied with its lot in the Indian Union since a famine hit the state in 1959. A Mizo National Famine Front was formed, which then became Mizo National Front. It asked for a separate state and then a country. Laldenga, an accountant by training, launched a movement in 1966 to claim independence. After years of violence, in 1986, there was an accord. Mizoram became a full Indian state and Laldenga its interim chief minister.



PRASHANT PANJIAR

Rs 7.50
the exchange rate of Indian rupee. Earlier pegged at Rs 4.76 to the US dollar, it was devalued for the first time in 1966.

117
people died when a Bombay-to-New York Air India flight crashed at Mont Blanc.

OF STARS AND STORIES

Bengali superstar Uttam Kumar played an insecure version of himself on a day's journey from Calcutta to Delhi by train, as a charming Sharmila Tagore (despite the glasses) quizzed him about his life in Satyajit Ray's *Nayak*. He was shown to be in a foul mood as the morning papers were filled with his being involved in an altercation and his latest film was slated to become his first flop. The film explored the psychology of the star and his admirers. She destroyed her notes because she felt journalists—yes, even they—should respect the privacy of stars.

